Critical Incident Stress Management Program

Purpose & Program Outline
Action Steps

ITEMS HIGHLIGHTED IN YELLOW = ACTION REQUIRED IMMEDIATELY FOLLOWING AN INCIDENT

Critical Incident Stress Management (CISM) Program

Purpose

The Critical Incident Stress Management (CISM) program is intended to help individuals exposed to critical incidents to identify and cope with their responses to these events. The focus of CISM is to provide "psychological first aid" and to minimize the harmful effects of job stress, particularly in crisis or emergency situations.

Program Outline

Critical Incident: Any event with sufficient impact to produce significant emotional reactions now or later. It is these unusually strong emotional reactions that have the potential to interfere with one's ability to function. It is generally considered extremely unusual in the range of ordinary human experiences. Examples of critical incidents include the following:

- Staff member's death
- Children's death or serious injury
- Drowning/Immersion incident
- Submersion Event
- Natural disasters
- Grotesque injuries
- Acts of violence resulting in injury or death
- Observing or involvement of any traumatic event

Critical Incident Stress Debriefing (CISD):

The CISD process offers a two fold approach. Initially as short-term intervention in the early stages post incident, it often aids in preventing some of the long-term cumulative effects associated with traumatic incidents. Over the long term the CISD process allows people to gain insight and view an incident from a different and more beneficial viewpoint. CISD allows for a "safe" judgment free arena that allows people the opportunity to talk, express their feelings, discuss any concerns arising from the incident and most essentially to prevent them from 'bottling up' their feelings. It is when this 'bottling up' of feelings happens that psychological distress becomes a concern. This is a pro-active small group process, usually no more than 30 minutes, ideally done within 8 hours after a critical incident. Purpose is:

- To mitigate the impact of a critical incident and to accelerate *normal* recovery in people with *normal* reactions to an ABNORMAL event.
- Rapid reduction in the intense reactions to a traumatic event.
- "Normalize" the experience so people can return to their routine duties as quickly as possible.
- Re-establish the group's social network so people do not isolate themselves from each other. In recognizing similarities to others, people often are more willing to help each other in troubled times.
- Provide information on acute stress and a few reminders about how to reduce it

- Assess group's response to determine if a full debriefing should be scheduled

Long Term Consequences of Unresolved Critical Incident Stress:
It is common for a person experiencing Critical Incident Stress (CIS) to remain in this state for some period of time. Where as, normal stress responses, usually rapidly subside when time off of other rest and recreational activities are undertaken, it is common for CIS to remain active or reoccur for long periods of time. When there is inadequate resolution to the incident for an individual, continuing difficulties tend to undermine work performance, personal identity, family relationships, and social life, and lead to increased susceptibility to ill health. Many factors effecting such outcomes are the nature of the incident, the way it is managed by direct supervisors, and more senior managers, the involvement of the community or media, lack of personal support networks, and pre-existing or subsequent vulnerabilities.

2 Kinds of typical consequences to trauma are:

- Re-experiencing the event as if the incident is happening again, including constant intrusive thoughts, or anxiety about the event occurring.
- Withdrawal or denial of the event. An attempt is made to avoid feeling or thinking about the event, to escape or cover up using addictions, busying oneself, or not fulfilling work or personal obligations.

Critical Incident Stress Management (CISM):
A system of interventions designed to mitigate the adverse psychological reactions that may accompany critical incidents. The CISM process is not therapy; its focus is to minimize the harmful effects through psychological first aid, education and follow-up. The CISM process uses trained peers and professional resources and is conducted by the CISM Team.

Critical Incident Stress Management Team: Shall consist of the following members:

- David Zehnder, Recreation Director
- Peter Beireis, Sr. Recreation Supervisor
- Nick Cuevas, Aquatic Coordinator
- Samantha Fallon, Aquatic Coordinator
- Fire Chaplains
- Psychologist/Psychiatrist

Critical Incident
Action Steps

- ◻ Call the appropriate emergency medical professionals (Police, Fire, EMS, 911).
- ◻ Call David, Peter, Samantha, and Nick to notify them of the incident; They will call John, Terrence, and David Benoun.
- ◻ Assign staff to identify witnesses to complete a Witness Statement form.
- ◻ Following the emergency and witness gathering, gather staff in the Meeting Room on the activity side or in the staff conference room.
- ◻ Have each staff immediately complete a Staff Statement form independently. Do not have them talk to each other.
- ◻ Do not allow media inside the facility. DO NOT speak to any media.
- ◻ The Senior Lifeguard or Manager will complete a Rescue Report and Accident Report.
- ◻ A Senior Lifeguard or Manager will complete the Confidential Incident Report.
- ◻ David, Peter, Samantha and/or Nick will conduct individual staff debriefings as well as a group debriefing.
- ◻ **IF DIRECTED BY CISM TEAM:** Contact professional resources or Fire Champlain's for assistance for the all staff incident debriefing.
- ◻ Gather all staff for an incident debriefing.
- ◻ Take photographs of the emergency equipment used.
- ◻ A supervisor (Samantha, Nick, or Peter) will notify staff's parents of the incident and assistance available to their child.
- ◻ A Supervisor (Samantha, Nick or Peter) will make the decision to re-open or close.
- ◻ All staff should be reminded to only discuss this matter with the CISM Team, or Family (Do not discuss with co-workers that were not present and do not post on social media sites).

Critical Incident Stress Management Program

Action Time-Table
Signs & Signals of Stress
Post CISM Reactions
Emergency Contact Form/List

Critical Incident
Action Time-Table

First Hour

- Assess the affect of the situation on the staff and site.
- Get names of witnesses and their statements (Witness Statement Document).
- Notify management – following the Chain of Command/Emergency Contact List.
- Ask Supervisor to notify family of the victim.
- If directed by CISM Team: Contact Fire Chaplain or professional resources.
- Close site until it is deemed safe and staff available to re-open.
- Post signage stating closing.
- Sr. Guard fills out accident/incident reports.
    - Sr. Guard may need to call in additional staff for coverage.

Next 2 –4 Hours

- Remove staff directly involved in the incident from the rotation.
  (Meet in the Activity side conference room)
- Interview staff and get Staff Statements completed.
- Instruct staff not to talk to the public, each other, or post on social media.
- Re-create a site schematic with location of staff at time of incident.
- Keep in contact with appropriate medical personnel.
- Consult with management and legal department.
- Designate a media contact.

Next 5 – 24 Hours

- Try to keep staff calm and in touch with reality.
- Prepare Confidential Incident Report.
- Gather all needed documents (See document section).
- Start compiling these records and reports.
- Meet with staff to begin stress debriefing and monitor emotional conditions.
- Reinforce positive image to remove negative public perception.
- Review established procedures and assess effectiveness.

Next 2 – 7 Days

- Create a central file for gathering of all information.
- Re-interview staff for any additional information or changes to statements.
- Keep good written records of all telephone and in-person conversations.
- Further grief counseling and stress debriefing for staff as needed.
- Remember you may be wearing many different hats:
    1. One for management
    2. One for the public
    3. One for your staff

  Note that each role has a different purpose and should carry with it a different demeanor.

Signs & Signals of a Stress Reaction

Cognitive

- Placing blame (**EMS took too long, someone else didn't do their job; etc**.)
- Confusion
- Poor Attention (**mind wanders back to incident**)
- Difficulties making decisions (**fear of making a wrong one**)
- Hyper Alertness
- Memory problems
- Poor problem solving
- Nightmares (**about the incident**)
- Seeing/reliving the event over and over

Emotional

- Anxiety
- Guilt – **most common**
- Intense anger
- Irritability
- Grief
- Denial
- Panic reactions
- Emotional shock
- Fear
- Loss of emotional control – **very common**
- Inappropriate emotional response
- Apprehension
- Feeling overwhelmed
- Feeling lost/abandoned
- Wishing to hide/die
- Uncertainty
- Depression – **very common**

Behavioral

- Crying spells
- Withdrawal – **one to watch**
- Anti-social acts – (**e.g. violence**)
- Emotional outbursts
  - Suspiciousness
  - Loss or increase of appetite
  - Alcohol consumption
  - Inability to rest
- Non-specific bodily complaints
- Excessive silence
- Excessive humor
  - Startle reflex intensified
  - Pacing
  - Erratic movements

Physical

- Chest pain *
- Difficulty breathing *
- Shock symptoms *
- Collapse from exhaustion *
- Excessive dehydration *
- Dizziness *
- Excessive vomiting *

*Indicates a need for medical attention

  - Headaches
  - Grinding of teeth
  - Chills
  - Profuse sweating
  - Nausea/Fatigue
  - Sleep disturbances
  - Vision Problems

POST Critical Incident Stress

Reactions

- Heightened sense of danger
  - Anger/blame
  - Isolation/ withdrawal
  - Flashbacks/ intrusive thoughts
  - Emotional numbing
  - Depression
  - Alienation
  - Fear/ anxiety about future situations
  - Guilt/sorrow/ remorse
  - Nightmares
  - Problems with the "system" – system didn't work
  - Family problems
  - Feelings of insanity
  - Loss of control
  - Alcohol/ drug abuse

Intensity of reactions tends to fade over time, peaking during the first few weeks and then gradually subsiding

Potential Signs of Fear in Emergency Responders

- Continual absence or tardiness to drills, trainings, or work
- Frequent moving to back of the line during training
- Excessive time spent getting ready, checking equipment, making adjustments
- Behavior that is inappropriate to the situation
- Multiple reported minor illness or injuries precluding training or responding

Training provided to staff teaches them to react to the emergency and not to think about the emergency. They do not begin to think about what has just occurred until the incident has concluded!

Emergency Contact List
City of Newark

Name	Position	Phone #
EMERGENCY	Newark Police Police Dispatch	**911** 510-578-4237
David Zehnder *	Recreation Director	925-820-7580 Cell 510-227-9650 Home
Peter Beireis *	Sr. Recreation Supervisor	510-421-8942 Cell 510-865-3844 Home
Nick Cuevas *	Aquatic Coordinator	951-333-4970 Cell
Samantha Fallon *	Aquatic Coordinator	(650) 346-0862 Cell
John Becker	City Manager	510-278-9525
Terrence Grindall	Assistant City Manager	209-275-2821
David Benoun	City Attorney	510-673-6956 Cell 510-796-1079 Home
	Fire Chaplain	
	MHN "Employee Assistance"	1-800-327-0010
Commander Michael Carroll	Media Information Officer	510-578-4220
Organization	**Reason**	**Phone #**
Newark Police	Emergency Mtc. Call out	510-578-4237
Newark Police Dispatch	Non-Emergency Line	510-578-4237
Alameda County Fire	Non-Emergency Dispatch	925-447-4257
California Poison Control	Chemical Information	1-800-222-1222
PG & E	Electric & Natural Gas	1-800-743-7683
Alameda County Water Dist	Water Emergency	510-668-6500
Alameda County Environmental Health	Pool Inspection	510-567-6700
Crisis Response-Mental Health	Assistance	1-800-491-9099
Animal Control	Dangerous/Lost Animal	510-578-4237
Child Protected Services	Child Abuse Hotline 24/7	510-259-1800
Suicide Prevention	Assistance	1-800-273-8255
CA Youth Crisis	Assistance	1-800-843-5200
City of Newark	City Services	510-578-4000
Newark Unified School Dist	School	510-818-4103
*** Call IMMEDIATELY as soon as life saving measures is under control!**		

Critical Incident Stress Management Program

Documents to Obtain

Documents to Obtain

- ❑ Rescue Report, Accident/Incident Reports
- ❑ In-service Training Agendas & Attendance Records
- ❑ American Red Cross Certifications (with expiration dates)
- ❑ Staff Manual
- ❑ Pool Chemical Readings
- ❑ County Health Department Inspection Reports
- ❑ Waiver: Swim Lessons, group rental, membership (if available)
- ❑ Responder reports (Police / Fire)
- ❑ OSHA Training Records
    - o Waterslide Operations
    - o Bloodborne Pathogen
    - o Chemical Training
- ❑ AED Daily Check-List
- ❑ Oxygen Daily Check-List
- ❑ Staff Manual(s)
- ❑ American Red Cross Lifeguard Textbook
- ❑ Audit Videos

All documents should be labeled "Privileged and Confidential Communication to City Attorney"

Critical Incident Stress Management Program

Witness Statement
Staff Statement
Confidential Incident Report
Supervisor Debriefing Sheet

PRIVILEGED AND CONFIDENTIAL COMMUNICATION TO CITY ATTORNEY

Witness Statement

Privileged and Confidential Communication to City Attorney

Witness Name: _____ **D.O.B.** _____

Address: _____ **Zip Code:** _____

Phone: (_____)_____

Date of Incident: _____ **Time of Incident**: _____

Did you observe the victim prior to the incident? (Y / N)
If yes, what was the victim doing at the time:

How long until Police, Fire, or Paramedics arrived?

How long had you been at the pool?

Estimate the number of patrons in the pool:

Where were you during the incident?

Have you spoken w/ any media? (Y / N) if yes, with whom & what was said?

Can you identify any other witness? (Y / N) if yes, whom?

Please write a description of the incident.
(Please be as specific and detailed as possible)

Signature: _____ **Date & Time:** _____

Staff Statement

Privileged and Confidential Communication to City Attorney

Date of Incident: _____ Time of Incident: _____

Location of Staff Member at time of Incident: _____

What was Staff Member doing at time of Incident: _____

_____

Please write a description of your role during the incident

(Please be as specific and detailed as possible)

Name of Staff Member (Print): _____

Signature of Staff Member: _____

Confidential Incident Report

Privileged and Confidential Communication to City Attorney

Phone Number: (___)_____ Date & Time: _____

Date of incident _____ Day _____ Time (am / pm)

Attendance _____ # of Guards on duty _____ Fully Staffed? (Y / N)

Time of last rotation _____ (am / pm) Water Depth of Incident _____ ft.

Chemical Readings:	Controller Readings	Manual Reading
▪ pH	_____	_____
▪ Chlorine	_____	_____
▪ HRR	_____	_____
▪ Temp	_____	_____

Water Quality: (circle one) Clear Turbid Still Moving

Can you see the Main Drain? (Y / N)

Description

Who activated the Emergency Action Plan? _____

Who called 911 and at what time? _____

How long until EMS arrived? _____

Who removed the victim? _____

Who did the initial patient assessment? _____

Guard(s) involved in the incident

Name _____ DOB __/__/__ Phone (___)_____

Address _____ Zip _____

Type of certifications (attach copies) _____

Last in-service attended _____ Amount of sleep evening prior_____

Position/stand on pool deck at the time of incident: _____

Did you observe the victim prior to the incident: (Y / N) if yes, what was their condition & activity?

Name _____ DOB __/__/
Phone (___)_____
Address _____ Zip _____

Type of certifications (attach copies) _____

Last in-service attended _____ Amount of sleep evening prior _____
Position/stand on pool deck at the time of incident: _____

Did you observe the victim prior to the incident: (Y / N) if yes, what was their condition & activity? _____

Name _____ DOB __/__/
Phone (___)_____
Address _____ Zip _____

Type of certifications (attach copies) _____

Last in-service attended _____ Amount of sleep evening prior _____
Position/stand on pool deck at the time of incident: _____

Did you observe the victim prior to the incident: (Y / N) if yes, what was their condition & activity? _____

Name _____ DOB __/__/
Phone (___)_____
Address _____ Zip _____

Type of certifications (attach copies) _____

Last in-service attended _____ Amount of sleep evening prior _____
Position/stand on pool deck at the time of incident: _____
Did you observe the victim prior to the incident: (Y / N) if yes, what was their condition & activity? _____

Supervisor Debriefing Sheet
(For Supervisor Use Only)

To be used after a Critical Incident (such as breathing/cardiac emergency, spinal, hospitalization, death)

- Talk to each employee involved in the incident in private prior to letting them return to work.
- Begin debriefing of the staff with those who were hands on with the victim or closest in dealing with the incident.

Employee Name _____ Date _____ Time_____

Facility _____ Nature of Incident_____

Ask the employee the following question:

1. Do you feel capable of returning to work and carrying out your duties with the effectiveness necessary to ensure the safety of all patrons?
    - **If YES**, continue with the Debriefing Sheet
    - **If NO**, keep staff on site until it is determined if they need a ride home or further debriefing with a grief counselor. Contact employee's parents/guardian, if a minor.
        - o If the employee is sent home, they should be instructed to report back to work at their next assigned shift.

Listen carefully to their responses to the following questions and use their answers to fill in any signs that they are not capable of returning to work.

2. How do you feel the staff responded to the accident?

3. How do you feel you responded to the accident? Why did you respond this way?

4. What if anything could have been done differently?

The following are signs that the employee may not be capable of returning immediately to work:
(Any of the following could disqualify them to return immediately to work)

___ Placing blame
___ Confusion
___ Poor attention (mind wanders back to accident)
___ Difficulty making decisions
___ Memory problems
___ Guilt
___ Intense anger
___ Irritability
___ Grief
___ Denial
___ Panic reactions
___ Fear
___ Depression
___ Uncertainty (returning back to work)
___ Crying spells
___ Withdrawal from the accident
___ Emotional outbursts
___ Inappropriate humor
___ Pacing
___ Erratic movements
___ Dizziness
___ Trembling (lips or hands)
___ Profuse sweating
___ Altered personality

Supervisor Recommendation:

- ○ **Employee should return to work**

- ○ **Employee relieved from work and should return to their next assigned shift**

Supervisor conducting debriefing: _____

Supervisor signature: _____

*Keep completed forms. If an employee is relieved for the day, when the employee returns to their next assigned shift, watch their behavior closely to see if other signs of stress develop. If so, address those concerns immediately. Further debriefing with a chaplain or counselor may be necessary.

RETURN TO WORK INTERVIEW:

Employee interviewed again to assess their general emotional state.

Supervisor: _____ DATE: _____

How are you feeling?

_____

_____

What have you been doing since the incident?

_____

_____

Did you contact or talk to anyone about the incident?

_____

_____

If another issue happened today would you be able to respond?

_____

_____

Supervisor: Have employee member perform CPR/Skills audit to check for readiness.
PASS _____ NO PASS _____ DATE _____ Supervisor _____

Employee: I feel that I'm able to return to work under normal conditions and can perform my job duties as needed for the position.

_____ _____ Date: _____

Employee Name **Employee Signature**

Critical Incident Stress Management Program

Media Interview Guide
Media Interview Statements
Aquatic Section Information

Media Interview Guide

(To be used by Newark management staff ONLY)
Prior to an interview or press conference review the following to help guide you through the process.
Make available & hand out press packets.

Before the Interview

- Ask what the interview is about. Who else the reporter is talking to, what information the reporter wants from you.
- Gather the information, simplify it and think of positive ways to relate it.
- Anticipate questions your answers may generate.
- Prepare answers for the toughest questions the report may ask.
- Develop one or two key points you want to make - short, positive statements that define or describe your program or issue.
- Avoid defensive statements and arguments.

During the Interview

- Your gestures, facial expressions and tone of voice say more about you than your words.
- Maintain steady eye contact with the reporter.
- Say the most important thing you have to say first and say it best.
- Do not build to your conclusion.
- Listen carefully to each question and pause before beginning your answer.
- Avoid jargon, acronyms and technical terms.
- Simplify complex numbers or terms.
- Show relationships and use analogies.
- If you do not know the answer, say so and promise to get the answer.
- Do not speculate, guess or respond to "phantom authority".
- Do not offer personal opinions and do not speak for others.
- Avoid "off the record" statements (***There is no such thing***).
- Always tell the truth.
- If there is problem, say you are looking into it and shift to what you are doing now to correct the situation.
- When you have answered the question, stop talking.

Your statement / answers during the interview should do the following:

1. Show empathy and compassion
2. Show we know the facts
3. Show that we are looking for further information and investigating
4. Shows what the Department is doing
5. Shows a commitment to finding all the facts and resolving the issue
6. Tells the public where to go for further information or updates

Media Interview Statements

The following is a brief list of statements to consider using as deemed appropriate. Please review this list prior to any media coverage.

General Water & Swim Safety

- Our goal is to provide a safe and fun water recreation experience for the public; however water safety is a partnership between our staff and the public who use our facilities.
- We have a well-developed learn to swim program and would highly recommend that you enroll your child in a learn to swim program.
- The public can do its part to ensure safety by following common-sense tips:
    - Learn to swim and know your swimming ability;
    - Watch your children when they swim;
    - Active supervision by a responsible adult is necessary for all children;
    - Swim with a friend or family member and never alone;
    - Read the pool rules and follow them at all times.

Drowning

- This is a tragedy for everyone, and our hearts go out to the family and friends.
- The investigation is underway to determine what happened. We will update you with information as it becomes available.
- Meanwhile, assure the public that the swimming facilities are safe and trained lifeguards are on duty.
- The public can do its part to ensure safety by following these essential safety tips:
    - Learn to swim and know your ability;
    - Swim with friends or a family member;
    - Watch your children when they swim;
    - Read the pool rules and follow them at all times.

Submersion Event

This is mistakenly referred immersion as a near-drowning. Do not use this term and do your best to insert "Submersion Event" to the media.

- The investigation is underway to determine what exactly happened;
- Lifeguards responded in a professional manner and provided emergency care as dictated by their training by the American Red Cross and the City of Newark;
- This is a horrible day and our prayers are with the family and friends;
- Meanwhile, assure the public that the swimming facilities are safe and trained lifeguards are on duty.

- The public can do its part to ensure prevent submersion events by:
    - Learn to swim and know your ability;
    - Swim with friends or a family member;
    - Active adult supervision is necessary for all children;
    - Read the pool rules and follow them at all times.

Quality of Lifeguard Force

- We understand that the public trust us to provide highly-trained and qualified lifeguards.
- Lifeguards complete 30 hours of basic training being certified by the American Red Cross in: CPR/AED, rescue techniques, first aid, water safety, and emergency preparation.
- Newark Lifeguards complete an additional 10 hours of training prior to work to prepare them for the position and actions they take to save lives.
- Newark Lifeguards meet all county, state, and federal guidelines.
- Newark Lifeguards are under close supervision by a highly-trained Senior Lifeguard and/or Manager during all shifts.
- Lifeguards are one critical component of an extensive water-safety program that includes:
    - Swim lessons
    - Parent Supervision
    - Water Safety Education
    - Adhering to signage and poster rules
    - To enforce unsafe behavior and to warn guests of unsafe behavior
    - Accident prevention
    - PFD's
    - Safety Equipment

Other Useful Information

- The majority of Newark Lifeguards are in their late teens and early 20's.
- This is a year-round position, with 4-16 lifeguards on duty when pool is in operations.
- The public needs to help Lifeguards by listening to their directions, with active adult supervision of children under the age of 8 years or non-swimmers.

Aquatic Section Information

Staffing Numbers
May thru August: 90
September thru October: 60
November thru April: 60

Staff is assigned to work at the Silliman Family Aquatic Center

Staff Trainings, In-service, and Meetings

Pre-Summer Staff Trainings (May)
- Rookie Lifeguard Training: 6 hours
- Lifeguard Training: 15 hours
- Swim Lesson Instructor Training: 6 hours
- Senior Lifeguard Training: 8 hours

Summer In-service Trainings (June-August)
- Lifeguards: 3 hours every Friday=30 hours
- Senior Lifeguards: 3 hours Friday=30 hours
- Weekly Senior Lifeguard Meetings: 2 hour each week=20 hours

Off-Peak In-Service Trainings (September-January)
- Monthly Staff Training: 2-3 hours/month=18-27 hours
- Monthly Senior Lifeguards: 2 hours/month = 18 hours

Annual Staff Recertification Trainings (February-April)
- Lifeguard Training Review/Recertification: 12 hours

Rookie Lifeguard Training Topics
Emergency Action Plan, Water Rescue Training, Teamwork, Emergency Preparedness/Equipment & Response, Program Knowledge, and Facility Amenities overview

Lifeguard Training Topics
Water Rescue Trainings, Extrication, Emergency Equipment Use, Spinal Management, Bloodborne Pathogens, CPR/AED, Oxygen Use, Emergency Action Plan Scenarios, Teamwork, Communication, Problem Solving-Decision Making and Physical Conditioning

Swim Lesson Instructor Training Topics
Introduction/Review of the program, lesson levels, active instruction, facility overview, program set-up, progression of levels, parent interaction, and practice teaching with students

Summer In-Service Training Topics

CPR/AED Skills, First Aid for Public Safety Personnel Skills, Rescue Skills, Spinal Injury Management, Emergency Action Plan Scenarios, Emergency Oxygen Skills, Staff Manual, Swim Lessons, Teamwork, Communication, Risk Management, Hydro Physical Ability, Problem Solving / Decision Making, Customer Service

Senior Lifeguard Training Topics

All above topics, Active Aquatics Supervision, Facility Operations, Performance Evaluations, Emergency Management, Leadership & Duty, Staff Development, Maintenance Basics, Facility Inspections, Report Writing, Troubleshooting, and Coaching & Leading others

Certifications

Lifeguards

- American Red Cross Lifeguard Training and First Aid
- Water Park Skills
- CPR/AED for Professional Rescuer/Healthcare Provider
- Administering Emergency Oxygen

Senior Lifeguards

- American Red Cross Lifeguard Training and First Aid
- CPR/AED for Professional Rescuer/Healthcare Provider
- Water Park Skills
- Administering Emergency Oxygen
- Water Safety Instructor

Additional that some staff possess:

- Lifeguard Training Instructor (highly desirable)
- American Red Cross Lifeguard Management
- Certified Pool Operator (highly desirable)
- Emergency Medical Technician

Full Time Staff

- American Red Cross Lifeguard Training and First Aid
- Water Park Skills
- CPR/AED for Professional Rescuer/Healthcare Provider
- Administering Emergency Oxygen
- Water Safety Instructor
- Lifeguard Training Instructor Trainer
- Water Safety Instructor Trainer
- First Aid for Public Safety Personnel Instructor
- Aquatic Facility Operator
- Certified Public Pool Operator

Evaluations and Inspections

Program Evaluations: Each program is evaluated annually
Staff Manual Updates: Annually
Emergency Equipment Inspections: Daily
Lifeguard Performance Evaluation:

- June – August: 1 per staff
- Sept. – May: As needed

Water Slide Inspections: Daily when in use

Independent unannounced audits – Total Aquatic Management

Ongoing inspections by OSHA Amusement Ride Division

County of Alameda Health Department

CERS: California Environmental Reporting System